

NOVELISTIC SCREENPLAY

POKÉMON NOCTURNE

EPISODE 01

The Imprecation of the Pokédex Holders

Author

Adelbert Vervloet

Working compilation

Status · draft · pass 1/3 recorded · EN-GB apparatus

Format	Novelistic screenplay · EN anchors
Target duration	To be set — corpus $\approx$ 100 min read aloud
Scenes	20
Version	2026-09-23 · EN-GB dossier after P1

Unofficial non-commercial fan work. Text and commissioned artwork may not be redistributed or commercially reused without permission, subject to the rights of the respective underlying IP holders.

Episode sheet

Series Pokémon Nocturne

Episode 01 — The Imprecation of the Pokédex Holders

Author Adelbert Vervloet

Logline

Oak hands over the Balls with an imprecation: to bind or to oppress. Red refuses the Dex against ordinary trainers, admits it against Rocket. At Viridian, the strongest Gym Leader proves a predator. A green badge remains in the palm. Green says: Let's battle.

Place in the arc

Due: Oak's tariff; Misty; the Dex as privilege; Giovanni; the man in white; Mewtwo still unformed.

Paid: Red names the ugliness; Charizard falls under Stone Edge; Lapras closes on Rhydon.

Open: rhetorical dissolution of Rocket; the fate of the strongest; Green; the Coyote unnamed here.

Characters — this episode only

Name	Function here
Red	Chooses Charmander; selective Dex; pays Viridian
Green	Squirtle; Dex on show; Let's battle
Misty	Anchor; water / land; phone box
Oak	Founding imprecation
Giovanni	Rotten summit; rules without a moral tariff
Blue	Ivysaur; Misty's jealousy
Man in white	Greeting at Silph; unnamed

Places (EN anchors)

Pallet Town · Oak's Lab · Cerulean Gym / Aquarium · Mt. Moon · Route 24 · Saffron / Silph Co. · Pokémon Mansion · Viridian Gym · Viridian phone box · Route 22.

Motifs to hold

Ball = bond or oppression · Dex = imprecation · level invisible outside a Gym · impure badge · spectre without omnipotence.

Technical notes — outside the scenes

None of this remains in the narrative. The body shows the blow; the sheet counts the pieces.

Scene	Note (do not paste into the narrative)
Rotten summit	Battle 5 vs 5. When Nidoking faces Charizard: Giovanni still has Rhydon; Red still has 2 Pokémon + Charizard. Off-menu: Charizard has just knocked out one of Giovanni's Pokémon.
Ugliness of predators	Espeon → Psychic (Nidoking). Recall. Lapras → Hydro Pump (Rhydon). Alternative BGM cut, Family in Heart: after “hideous”, before the indictment.
Elegant spectre	Moves to cite in EN in the narrative, not pasted as labels: Flamethrower, Air Slash, Dragon Claw, Wing Attack, Bonemerang, Confusion, Sludge.
Deadly frivolity	All damage / level / PP notes out of the body (p. 10 of the copy). Raticate at level 16 in RGB.
Warmth of Water	A Third Soul: cut at 01:36 or 01:48.
The Fate of the Strongest	The quote from *The Great Gatsby*, in which Nick Carraway criticises Tom Buchanan and Daisy Buchanan: “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money or their vast carelessness, or whatever it was that kept them together, and let other people clean up the mess they had made. . . .”

BGM index — pieces

Scene	Piece	Span
Intuition of first love	Always	→ 00:28
Imprecation	Making Monsters	00:00 / 00:54 / 01:23
World is a matrix	She Who Mauls · Powerful Predatory Deadly	→00:24 · 02:22–03:21
Deadly frivolity	She Who Mauls	01:25 · 02:56–end
Despite jealousy	Don't Listen to Her	→ 01:05
Ethical decision	Vampire Messiah	00:46–01:17
Flame / transformation	Little Boy Belmont	→00:25 · 00:25 · 01:45
Heart taking the blow	Part of the Same History	01:07–

A part stripped bare	Powerful Predatory Deadly	00:44–cut
Blindness	She Who Mauls	00:41–00:45 (effect)
Warmth of Water	A Third Soul	→ 01:36 or 01:48
Elegant spectre	My Sister	00:30 · 01:30 · 01:54 · 02:11–end
Rotten summit	Reborn	span to be fixed
Ugliness	Family in Heart	to the end (+ alternative cut)
Let's battle	Vampire Messiah	01:38–

BGM index — traces

Scene	Trace
Shameful jealousy	Trace · EP02 S02 11:21–11:35 (~55 s)
Spontaneous surrender	Trace · EP01 S02 16:46–17:00
Despite jealousy	Trace · EP01 S02 04:30–05:40
Rocket implacability	Trace · EP02 S01 06:30–07:28
Blindness	Trace · EP04 S02 18:10–19:00
Fate of the strongest	Trace · EP04 S01 03:47–05:00

Order of scenes

1. The Intuition of First Love
2. The Imprecation of the Pokédex Holders
3. The World Is a Matrix
4. Shameful Jealousy
5. Deadly Frivolity
6. Spontaneous Surrender
7. Despite Jealousy
8. The Ethical Decision
9. The Filamentous Flame
10. Equivocal Transformation

11. The Heart Taking the Blow
12. A Part Stripped Bare
13. The Implacability of Team Rocket
14. The Childhood Friend's Blindness
15. The Warmth of Water
16. The Elegant Spectre
17. The Rotten Summit
18. The Ugliness of the Supreme Predators
19. The Fate of the Strongest
20. Let's Battle バトルしようぜ

The scenes are inserted here. The close follows the body.

Scene – The Intuition of First Love

Cerulean Gym swimming pool, daytime

The surface of the pool rippled gently in the daylight. Misty emerged from the water with fluid grace, her movements still imbued with that natural grace that characterised her. She climbed onto the edge without haste, water trickling down her body. She sat there for a moment, her eyes cast down towards the reflections dancing on the surface.

The boredom had not really gone away.

She stood up, picked up the towel lying on a nearby bench and rubbed her arms and hair with slow, almost mechanical movements. Her gaze remained somewhat distant. Swimming had not been enough to wash away the bitter taste of her previous defeat. Worse still: she felt as though it had made her even more aware of her irritation.

A member of staff approached, holding a piece of paper.

‘A new challenge, Miss Misty.’

She took the form without a word, politely. Her eyes quickly scanned the details. When she reached the trainer’s origin, her expression hardened slightly.

Pallet Town.

The same town as the last one. She carried on reading. The name was written below: **Red**.

She remained silent for a moment, her gaze fixed on the paper. Then she nodded slightly, in an almost imperceptible movement. The staff member walked away to fetch the challenger.

Misty folded the form and placed it on the bench. She readjusted the towel around her shoulders, her fingers clenching the fabric slightly. She wasn’t quite sure how she felt. A sort of weariness mixed with a vague curiosity.

A few moments later, light footsteps echoed across the damp tiled floor.

Red approached, accompanied by a small orange Pokémon she did not recognise at once. Charmander walked beside him, its tail bearing a bright, steady flame. Red stopped at a respectful distance. He looked a little impressed by the place, but not intimidated.

He looked at her and spoke in a calm, almost gentle voice:

‘...Hello. My name is Red.’

BGM: ‘Always’ until 00:28

Misty looked up.

First she saw the Pokémon. It was small, cute, with an almost childlike expression. Then her gaze moved up to the boy standing before her.

He was about her age. His hair was brown and grey, a bit tousled, and his expression was calm, without a trace of arrogance. He didn’t seem to be there to humiliate her or to prove anything. Just to challenge the Gym.

Something stirred within her.

It was not violent. It was not even immediate. Yet a gentle, unexpected warmth spread through her chest, contrasting strangely with the irritation she'd felt until then. Her fingers tightened a little more firmly on the edges of the towel. She felt her breathing change, becoming slightly shallower. Her gaze lingered on Red's face for longer than she would have liked.

There was a quiet kindness about him that did not feel forced in the slightest. It was not naivety. It was something else. Something rarer.

Misty opened her mouth to reply, but no sound came out straight away. She blinked, as if trying to regain control. A faint blush rose to her cheeks, which she couldn't quite suppress. Her expression softened in spite of herself. Her shoulders, usually held proudly, relaxed slightly. Her gaze became gentler, almost vulnerable, fixed on Red without her really being able to look away.

Red, feeling a little uncomfortable at her prolonged silence, lowered his gaze slightly towards Charmander and absent-mindedly stroked its head, without pressing the matter.

Misty stood there, unable to formulate a clear reply. She felt something unfamiliar and unsettling welling up inside her, too strong and too sudden for her to contain it entirely. It wasn't just attraction. It was deeper, more dangerous, and at the same time strangely sweet.

She finally drew a quiet breath, her lips slightly parted, her gaze still fixed on him with an expression she could no longer quite hide.

End of scene

Scene – The Imprecation of the Pokédex Holders

Professor Oak's laboratory, daytime

BGM: *'Making Monsters'*

Professor Oak's laboratory was larger than most people imagined. White walls and large bay windows admitted a bright, almost excessively neutral light. Rows of tables and equipment stood alongside spacious enclosures where several specimen Pokémon roamed freely. The place resembled a functional manor house more than a simple laboratory. Everything here seemed to have been designed with a certain ethical design in mind: the space, the light, the tranquillity.

Yet the atmosphere felt heavy.

Red and Green stood facing a long table. Three Poké Balls lay on it, precisely aligned. Professor Oak stood slightly to one side, his hands clasped behind his back. He watched the two teenagers without saying a word.

The silence was sharp.

Red kept his eyes downcast, fixed on the three Poké Balls. His face was calm, but his shoulders were slightly tense. Beside him, Green was trying to appear detached. His arms were crossed, his gaze unfocused, but his fingers were discreetly clenching the fabric of his sleeve. Every now and then he would cast a quick glance at Red, then look away immediately.

Professor Oak made a small, simple, silent gesture with his hand. He nodded slightly towards Red, then towards the three Poké Balls.

Red understood. So did Green.

Oak invited him to choose first. Out of politeness, without any apparent favouritism. Red hesitated for a fraction of a second, then stepped forward slowly. Green stayed where he was. He lowered his eyes slightly, his jaw clenched. He knew why Oak had made that gesture. He also knew there was nothing to be said against it. Yet something inside him tightened. He did not move, but his gaze grew a little darker.

Red came to a halt before the table. He studied the three Poké Balls for several seconds. His gaze lingered a little longer on the one in the centre. At length he picked it up. The Poké Ball felt cold against his palm. He lifted it carefully, almost reverently.

Inside, Charmander was looking at him through the transparent surface. The little Pokémon's eyes were bright and curious. Red felt a vague sense of joy welling up inside him, mingled with something more complex that he couldn't yet put into words. The creature's red colour, the little flame at the tip of its tail... it spoke to him. He gently pressed the Poké Ball to his chest.

Green waited a moment longer before stepping forward in turn. He took the ball on the right without really hesitating. Squirtle. He held it for a moment, his gaze slightly distant. Something in his expression wavered. He looked down at the ball, then at his own green jacket. He said nothing, but his fingers tightened slightly around the sphere.

Red, who was watching discreetly, felt a slight shadow fall over his enthusiasm. He had not anticipated Green's choice. They did not know each other well enough for that. And yet, seeing the Squirtle Poké Ball in the other boy's hand, he vaguely realised that he might have just put himself at a disadvantage. It was not a clear thought. Just a feeling – unpleasant and vague.

He did not judge Green. Nor was he angry. Only a faint regret at having chosen first. As if, without intending to, he had placed himself at a disadvantage.

Professor Oak had not moved. He had watched the proceedings in silence, his face impassive but attentive. He had seen the slight tensing of Green's shoulders. He had also seen the way Red was now clutching his Poké Ball a little tighter. He knew why Green had chosen Squirtle. He knew it, and it did not really reassure him.

He finally broke the silence. His voice was calm, almost gentle, but it carried an unusual weight.

"You should know that Poké Balls aren't meant to imprison Pokémon..."

BGM: 'Making Monsters' (from 00:54)

He paused briefly, looking from one teenager to the other.

"Through them, we can befriend them... or become their oppressors. It all depends on our will. The same goes for science."

The two boys remained silent. Their expressions darkened slightly. Green lowered his gaze a little further. Red kept his eyes fixed on the Poké Ball he was holding.

Professor Oak slowly turned his head towards Red. His tone remained measured, but his words seemed to carry more weight.

“Presumably... the same goes for the flame you represent, Red.”

BGM: ‘Making Monsters’ from 01:23

Red did not reply. He kept his eyes downcast on the Poké Ball. The compliment — if it was one — brought him no warmth. On the contrary. He felt those words as something weighing on his shoulders, rather than as recognition. The flame he represented... He didn’t know exactly what that meant, but it didn’t seem like a light matter to him.

The atmosphere in the laboratory seemed to grow a little heavier still. The light streaming in through the large windows seemed less bright than before. The three of them stood there for a moment, motionless and silent.

End of scene

Scene – The world is a matrix

Cerulean Municipal Aquarium, daytime

The aquarium’s main hall was bathed in a shifting blue light. The sun’s rays shone through the water in the tanks, casting shimmering reflections on the white walls and on people’s faces. All that could be heard was the gentle lapping of the water, a few bubbles rising to the surface, and the muffled murmur of visitors passing by the glass panels. The place smelled of clean water and a hint of salt.

Misty stood in front of a large tank, her arms crossed. She was wearing a simple, light-coloured dress, more smartly dressed than usual. Her hair was tied back more neatly. Red stood a short distance away from her, his shoulders slightly hunched. Charmeleon stayed close by his side, tail lowered, whilst Pikachu had sat down at the edge of the pool and was watching a group of Magikarp swimming lazily in the water.

Misty spoke first, without turning round completely.

“You... you might have dressed a little better.”

BGM: ‘She Who Mauls’ (up to 00:24)

Her voice was calm, but there was a hint of restraint in her tone. She was alluding to the defeat from earlier without naming it directly. Red lowered his head a little further. He didn’t reply straight away. His fingers clenched slightly around the hem of his jacket.

“You lost quite badly. I didn’t want to rub it in. But... it was obvious.”

Red kept his eyes fixed on the surface of the water. His fingers tightened slightly on the strap of his rucksack.

“...Actually, I’d done some research on your Pokémon beforehand,” he said at last. “But in the heat of battle... it was more complicated than I’d thought.”

He paused. His gaze drifted towards the water, then back to her.

“Your Starmie... it was just too strong for the second Gym... Even for Pikachu.”

Misty turned her head slightly. A small, bitter, almost resigned smile flitted across her face.

"It's true. People often point that out to me. But it's not my aim to frustrate the Trainers who come to challenge me."

Red kept his eyes downcast.

"...Thanks for not going all the way."

Their eyes met for a fraction of a second, then looked away at the same time, as if by tacit agreement. Misty replied very quietly:

"...You're welcome."

Silence fell. They stood there for a moment, gazing at the tank. Behind the glass, a Starmie was slowly spinning round and round, its purple appendages glowing faintly. Pikachu followed its movements with his eyes, ears pricked up. Charmeleon, on the other hand, seemed more restless: he was discreetly scratching the floor with the tip of his claw, without really realising it.

Red finally broke the silence, his voice a little hesitant.

'...Say, Misty. Does this place belong to you?'

Misty shook her head slightly.

"No. But I'm one of the co-chairs."

Red nodded, looking uncomfortable. He searched for the right words for a moment, then blurted out, without really thinking:

"You're really impressive, being a Gym Leader at your age."

Misty raised an eyebrow. Her voice remained polite, but took on a slightly sharper tone.

"It's not very nice to talk about a woman's age, you know."

Red stiffened immediately. A flush rose to his cheeks.

"Ah... I... sorry."

Misty sighed softly, but without any harshness.

"Even though I'm almost your age... I suppose you're not used to talking to girls."

Red's face flushed instantly. He looked as if he wanted to shrink into the ground. He quickly tried to make up for his awkwardness.

"You must have put a lot of effort into getting this job..."

Misty regarded him in silence for a moment; her expression softened slightly.

"Yes. I come from a well-off background, but it wasn't easy for me all the same. So I'm rightly proud of it."

Red could not think of anything to say. He looked down at his shoes, ashamed of his awkward questions. Misty seemed to sense this. She changed the subject slightly, her voice more neutral:

"This aquarium is open to the town's residents... and also to Professor Oak. His laboratory isn't really equipped to handle certain Water-type Pokémon."

Red looked up, surprised.

“Ah. I didn’t know that.”

Misty looked at him with a hint of kindness.

“It’s all right,” she said kindly. “You’ve only just left your town. Don’t worry.”

She turned back towards the tank. A long silence fell between them. Pikachu had stretched out along the edge of the glass, his tail swaying slowly. Charmeleon had moved closer to Red and was standing silently by his side.

Red finally asked another question, more gently:

“Why... did you choose the Water-type?”

Misty didn’t answer straight away. She kept her eyes fixed on the water. When she spoke, her voice was lower, almost introspective.

BGM: ‘Powerful Predatory Deadly’ (02:22–03:21)

“Gym Leaders don’t choose their type just because they feel like it. We specialise because it’s the most effective way to reach a truly high level. It’s better to master one area thoroughly than to be average at everything.”

She fell silent for a moment. Her gaze took on a distant look.

‘By working with Professor Oak, Gym Leaders are eligible to access partial data. It’s a give-and-take arrangement. He carries out his research. We, in turn, improve our skills.’

Red listened attentively. After a moment, he asked with obvious naivety:

“But... why don’t you just take the strongest Pokémon of your type, at a high level?”

Misty gave a small, bitter smile. She did not reply straight away. When she did, her voice was deeper:

“Because that’s not how it works.”

She paused. Her expression shifted slightly. She looked away towards the water.

“Some things... it’s better not to know. It’s too dark.”

Red felt the weight of those words. He asked no more questions. He stared at the Starmie circling behind the glass, looking a little lost.

After a long moment, he murmured:

“But isn’t betraying our own nature a bit extreme...?”

Misty kept her eyes on the water. Her smile, this time, was gentler, almost nostalgic.

“I chose Water because that’s what I know how to do. I’ve always been good at swimming. It’s in my nature. And thanks to that, I’ve learnt something.”

She gestured towards the creatures swimming behind the glass.

“Land and water do not always coexist easily. Most Water-type Pokémon cannot bear to remain on land for long. As a swimmer, I enter their world. I understand them a little better. That connection... I find it precious. It is as if the same holds true among people, too. I truly cherish it.”

Red listened to her without interrupting. He'd forgotten how to speak.

Misty continued, in a quieter voice:

"That is why I have Starmie. Not just because he is powerful. Because he embodies that idea so well. Mind you, not to pick on novice Trainers."

She said this with a slight, wry smile, but Red did not smile. He kept his eyes downcast.

Misty finally turned to face him.

"And you? When I saw your hometown and your odd little Pokémon... I didn't expect you to be one of the Professor's students as well."

Red immediately realised who she was referring to.

"...Green."

Misty nodded.

Misty continued:

"He took out his Pokédex during the battle. You've never done that. Why not?"

Red paused for several seconds before replying. His voice was low.

"At first, that wasn't my intention. But as I travelled... I realised that not all Trainers have the same resources. No Pokédex, no structured training. Some Trainers turn hostile after being beaten by Green... Because of his Pokédex, I think. So I prefer to battle like them. Without checking everything in advance."

He paused. His voice grew more serious.

"Outside the Gyms and the League... there's no way of gauging someone's level. So you have to make do with what you see and what you feel. Knowing when your opponent is starting to falter, or, conversely, when they're becoming too dangerous."

Misty listened intently.

"Oh. So you still don't use that against ordinary Trainers...?"

Red nodded.

"Not with them. But I do with a few... very dangerous people."

A silence fell. His expression shifted slightly. A shadow flitted across his eyes.

'Like those people in black... Team Rocket, if I'm not mistaken... When dealing with these individuals, it's *far too risky* not to know their exact strength and the discrepancy between us... if you value your life...'

Misty tensed imperceptibly. She said nothing, but it was clear she understood. Red, sensing her unease, quickly added:

"But I'm getting used to it. Having a Pokédex doesn't mean I don't have to learn discipline, intuition and humility. I recognise the value in those who don't have one. I'm not so different from them."

Misty looked at him for a long time. Her expression softened.

“You really are a strange boy...”

She murmured this almost gently, as if to herself, and looked away slightly, as though she did not want him to see that she was moved.

She sat up a little straighter.

“Anyway, you’re welcome to come to my gym. Good luck.”

She gave a polite little nod, signalling that the visit was drawing to a close.

End of scene

Scene – Abashed jealousy

Cerulean Aquarium

The aquarium’s lobby was vast, bathed in natural light that glinted off the tiled floor. Large windows looked out onto the indoor tanks, where the water moved slowly, almost silently. The place exuded a sense of space and calm, almost too vast for just two people.

Misty stopped dead.

A little further on, near one of the pillars, stood a girl. Beside her, an Ivysaur lazily raised its head. Misty watched her for a moment. Three starter Pokémon. Three Pokédex holders. She realised immediately. The rarity of the species and the balance of types (Water, Grass, Fire) made the conclusion obvious.

Red, for his part, did not seem to notice anything out of the ordinary. He turned his head slightly towards Misty.

“I’ll be back in a moment.”

His voice was matter-of-fact and polite. Without waiting for a reply, he walked over to the girl.

Misty stood back, her arms crossed. She watched them.

Red stopped at a respectful distance. He acknowledged Blue with a brief, almost professional nod. Their exchange was brief. He spoke in a neutral, direct tone, without excessive familiarity. He asked short questions about her background, listening to the answers attentively, but without any particular warmth. When Blue gestured towards Ivysaur, Red lowered his gaze slightly to look at the Pokémon, then looked up again. His expression remained calm and respectful. Nothing more.

Blue, for her part, stood a little straighter. Her answers were a little longer than necessary. Her eyes lingered on Red’s face for a fraction of a second too long before looking away. She was smiling, but the smile was a little too restrained, as if she were careful not to overdo it. Her fingers absent-mindedly brushed the edge of Ivysaur’s shell as she spoke.

Misty saw it all.

BGM: ‘EP02 S02 11:21 – 11:35’

She saw the way Red treated Blue: politely, with a sort of awkward kindness, but without any hint of particular closeness. Just as one might speak to a colleague. Nothing that resembled affection. And at the same time, she saw the way Blue was looking at him.

Blue eventually felt the weight of the gaze fixed upon her. She turned her head slightly. Her eyes met Misty's.

A moment passed.

Blue didn't smile. She didn't hold her gaze for long. She simply looked down at Ivysaur, with a calm, almost polite movement, then turned her attention back to Red as if nothing had happened. She didn't try to provoke her. Nor did she try to justify herself.

Misty was the first to look away.

She clenched her fingers slightly around her forearm, a small, almost imperceptible gesture. Her face remained impassive, but her shoulders had stiffened slightly. She wasn't quite sure how she felt. Only that it left a bitter, confusing taste in her mouth.

Red, from a distance, continued to speak to Blue in the same calm, neutral tone.

End of scene

Scene – Deadly Frivolity

Mt. Moon (depths)

Daylight struggled to reach this far down. The rock faces were cold and damp, and the air smelled of dust and mustiness. Pikachu stood facing the Raticate, its body trembling slightly.

BGM 'She Who Mauls' from 01:25,

The Raticate was unusually imposing for a specimen of that level. Even after being hit by Thunder Wave, it showed no sign of weakness. Its jaws snapped open with a sharp crack.

Pikachu was sent flying backwards. It hit the rocky ground and did not get back up.

Red gritted his teeth. He recalled Pikachu with a swift gesture. The Poké Ball returned to his palm in a red flash. Without hesitation, he threw another one.

Charmander appeared in a flash of light. It immediately took up its position, but Red could tell straight away that his Pokémon was already tired.

The Raticate lowered its head, its fangs still wet. It took a heavy step forward, despite the paralysis that was stiffening its limbs. The three Grunts formed a semicircle around Red. They said nothing. They just watched.

Red realised that standard attacks would not be enough. This Raticate was too strong, too fast, despite its condition. He hesitated for a second, then slipped his hand into his pocket.

He took out the Pokédex.

The device opened with a soft click. Red tapped the keys quickly, his eyes fixed on the screen. He was looking for its level, its abilities – any information that might help him.

A heavier silence fell.

BGM 'She Who Mauls' 02:56–end

The three Grunts had stopped moving. Their gazes were fixed on the object Red was holding in his hands. They still weren't speaking. They were simply watching, with sudden, intense focus. One of them tilted his head slightly, as if to get a better look.

Red felt their gaze upon him.

He looked up for a fraction of a second. He saw their expressions: no more mockery, just that cold, interested attention. He realised immediately what he had just done.

Even if they did not know what the device was, they would speak of it; they would describe it to their superiors. He had just made himself visible, not merely as a Trainer defending himself, but as one who possessed something unusual.

His thumb remained frozen above the Pokédex.

The Raticate let out a hoarse growl and charged again, more fiercely than before.

End of scene

Scene – The Spontaneous Surrender

Cerulean Gym

The water in the gym cast a cold glow onto the tiled walls. The battle was drawing to a close.

Starmie floated, still slightly slowed by paralysis, but clearly the superior fighter. Charmeleon, meanwhile, was panting. Its tail flame flickered, lower and more erratic than at the start of the battle. Despite the Water Pulse it had just taken, it remained standing, its claws dug into the ground, its gaze fixed on its opponent.

Misty watched, giving nothing away.

Red, however, could see the true state of his Pokémon. He could see the way Charmeleon was trembling slightly, the way its tail was losing its brilliance. He knew that his Pokémon would carry on until it was exhausted if he didn't stop it.

Starmie prepared to strike again.

Red realised, in a flash, that shouting would not be enough. Starmie was already on the move. He lunged forward with a heavy, clumsy stride.

His movement was abrupt, almost haphazard. He crossed the white line with a heavy stride and planted himself in front of Charmeleon, one arm stretched across his body as if to block it. Starmie froze instantly. The water around him calmed.

Charmeleon looked up, surprised. Its gaze fell on Red with sudden intensity — at once anxious and almost pained. It didn't understand why its Trainer was stopping it from continuing. Its eyes, usually sharp and determined, remained fixed on him, as if it were searching for an explanation it didn't dare ask for.

BGM: 'EP01 S02 16:46–17:00'

Red stood there for a few seconds, breathless, then he spoke. His voice was clear, but weak, almost hollow:

'I give up...'

Silence fell once more.

Red slowly knelt down. He kept his head bowed, one hand resting on the floor, the other still held out vaguely before him. He made no attempt to justify his action, nor to stand up again. He simply seemed overwhelmed by the weight of what he had just done.

Misty watched him without moving.

Starmie calmly retreated towards its trainer.

Her expression remained neutral, but something in her gaze shifted imperceptibly. She observed the way Red remained there, kneeling, making no attempt to soften the blow of his defeat. She also saw the way Charmeleon continued to look at him — loyal, worried, and strangely vulnerable. She said nothing. She simply remained motionless, arms crossed, her eyes fixed on that kneeling figure who refused to get back to his feet.

End of scene

Scene – Despite the jealousy

Café in Cerulean

The café was quiet, almost empty at the end of the afternoon. Light streamed in through the large windows and fell upon the light-coloured wooden tables. The place had a classic, almost Western feel to it, with its light-coloured walls and dark wooden chairs. All that could be heard was the soft clink of spoons against cups and the occasional murmur of the customers.

Misty was slowly stirring her spoon in her tea. Red was sitting opposite her, his shoulders slightly slumped, his gaze fixed on the table.

'How funny,' she said at last. 'You beat that boy... but you lost to me.'

She had not mentioned Green by name. Red noticed this, but did not comment on it.

"Did you only face him with Pikachu and Charmeleon?" she asked.

"No," replied Red. "I've got other Pokémon. But I stick to the 2-on-2 rules."

Misty nodded slightly.

"...All right."

A silence fell. Red hesitated, then asked a question he almost immediately regretted.

"Green was at your place before me...? That's odd. His Wartortle isn't as strong as your Starmie, is it?"

Misty twirled her spoon again. Her movements were slower than before. She did not tell him off, but something in her demeanour changed slightly.

"Yes," she said. "It was humiliating. The rules limit my Starmie's abilities. It couldn't fight back effectively. Whereas Wartortle used Bite... which is very effective against it. I couldn't defend myself properly. It was humiliating... for a Water-type specialist."

Red lowered his gaze. A guilty blush spread across his cheeks.

"Sorry," he murmured. "So that's why you were in a bad mood when we met..."

Misty remained silent for a moment. She seemed to be weighing her words.

"That boy wants to be the strongest Trainer," she said at last. "You, on the other hand, don't seem to. What a contradiction."

Red shrugged slightly.

"I've thought about it before. But I don't really want to. I don't collect Pokémon cards, or League posters, or photos of the champions."

Misty looked at him for a moment.

"Oh. You're the protégé of a legendary champion, but you don't want to become one yourself?"

"If you're talking about Professor Oak... He's a man of respect, yes. But not because he was a champion. He's a wise man. He helped our town, not just through his strength in battle, but through his ideas, through his way of seeing things. That's why I admire him. And that admiration was mutual. That's why he accepted my application."

Misty let out a little sigh, almost a joyless laugh.

"What madness."

She paused:

"He sent you to complete his Pokédex, if the rumours are true."

Red shook his head slowly.

"No. The Professor had already gathered some basic data. Our job is mainly to expand on that. Observing how Pokémon use their abilities, their behaviour, their temperaments... That sort of thing."

Misty raised an eyebrow.

"It is rather funny that he would entrust this sort of mission to children like you."

Red remained silent for a moment before replying.

"He said that travelling was good for young people. That it helped build discipline and broaden one's horizons. There are certain things you can only learn by travelling at that age. But he's also looking for successors. Even though he already has a grandson. Because he's getting on in years, I suppose."

Misty remained silent. She did not comment on Green this time.

Red finally asked the question that had been burning on his lips.

'Say... do you really hate Green that much? Just because you lost to him?'

Misty set down her spoon. Her tone remained calm, yet it was keener.

"Not really. He tried to keep up appearances. But he couldn't hide his arrogance... Even if he might not have meant to. As a Gym Leader, I felt like I was a trophy or a prize for him. It's... appalling."

Red lowered his head.

"You can forgive him, because I'm partly to blame too..."

Misty looked at him.

"What do you mean?"

Red kept his eyes fixed on the table.

"Green chose this Pokémon because he didn't want to be outdone by me."

His tone changed. It became more serious, more sombre.

"In truth, the Professor dispatched us here chiefly so that we might flourish alongside our starter Pokémon. They are rare species. There is still very little data on them. We do not truly know their potential... unlike what people say about us."

BGM 'Don't Listen to Her' until 01:05

Misty listened without interrupting.

"In this rivalry, it is not merely a matter of a Trainer's pride," continued Red. "Our Pokémon suffer too. I can see it is painful for Charmeleon to face Wartortle, so I avoid making them battle, to protect them, both physically and psychologically. And I can see that Wartortle is not comfortable with these battles either; even under Green's strict orders, he sometimes shows reluctance. It all seems too... complicated to them."

A moment of silence fell.

"As for me, I do not really hold a grudge against Green," said Red. "He has also borne the consequences of choosing against his nature. Sometimes, his little mannerisms show it. And to realise his dream, he has put a lot of effort in. I have bumped into him in libraries. So I do not criticise him too much. Even if his manners are sometimes... a bit inappropriate."

Red lowered his voice a little further.

"Green thinks that power alone can solve everything. I've never really shared that view. I often try to show the opposite. But sometimes... I get the feeling he might be right. It's strange."

His eyes gradually darkened.

"I'm not complaining that you're too strong, Misty. But I'm stuck here, whilst Green is moving forward. Sometimes, I'm not really sure what the real problem is. Am I not competent enough? Do I lack perseverance? Or... should I simply agree with Green and follow his method?"

His voice trembled slightly at the end. He was still feigning a kind of modesty, but you could sense he was on the verge of something much heavier.

Misty looked at him without saying a word for a few seconds. She saw his shoulders tense and his eyes begin to glisten. She realised he was on the verge of breaking down.

She placed her hands on the table.

"It's not worth you following his way, Red," she said simply.

Red lifted his head slightly, as if waking from a dream.

"You don't have to comfort me, really."

Misty shrugged slightly.

"I'm not used to it, if you must know."

She paused, then continued in a calmer voice:

"You're facing up to your weaknesses sooner than he is. That's all."

BGM 'EP01 S02 04:30–05:40'

Red did not reply straight away. He sat up a little, but remained hunched over.

Misty continued, this time with more conviction in her voice:

"I'm proud. That doesn't stop me from admitting my defeats. I'm even glad to meet challengers who've beaten me. I learn from them. Defeat is part of life, even if some battles can cost us dearly. I know that well, because I'm a Gym Leader."

She looked Red straight in the eye.

"I am not merely quoting proverbs to appear wise. 'Failure is the mother of success.' I do not truly believe that. Both failure and success can teach us things... if we are willing to learn from them. But they can also blind us, if we refuse to see what they have to tell us."

She clenched her hands slightly on the table.

"You're strong. You've already done well, even having chosen Charmander. If Green had chosen him, he wouldn't have done any better. I'm sure of it."

Red looked at her. He could sense that these words were not merely words of consolation; they were sincere. And yet there was something in Misty's tone that remained melancholic, almost bitter.

Misty lowered her gaze slightly.

'But just so you know: I won't be able to go too gently on you. In future, it won't just be me you'll have to outdo. There'll be others too... like Green, and the people in black.'

Red understood the implication. He nodded slowly.

Misty added, in a slightly lower voice:

"But you could still look for a Pokémon that has an advantage against Water-type Pokémon."

Red looked at her, surprised.

"What? Isn't that going a bit too far? And you're telling me this, despite your own type..."

Misty gave a small, joyless smile.

"It is the duty of Gym Leaders to accept such situations. Do not worry. You may consider it, if you truly need to."

She had said it with a certain harshness, as if forcing herself to utter the words. Red sensed it. He saw something flit across her face — a kind of bitterness she wasn't really trying to hide. As if she were allowing Red to borrow Ivysaur from Blue just to upset her. It is all the more poignant. She has brought this dilemma upon herself.

Misty remained silent after that. She stared at her cup, her fingers clenched around the spoon.

Red realised she was aware she'd said something that pained her. But he didn't know exactly what.

End of scene

Scene – The Ethical Decision

Route 24, dusk

The sky was taking on dark, cold hues above the road. The grass was already damp with dew. In the distance, one could hear the faint rustling of leaves in the evening breeze.

Blue stood facing Red, with Ivysaur at her side. Her arms were crossed, yet her posture betrayed a certain tension.

'Are you really sure you can manage without my Ivysaur...?'

Red remained silent for a moment before replying. His voice was calm, almost too composed.

"Yes."

Blue lowered her gaze slightly. She seemed to want to press the point, but the words wouldn't come easily.

BGM 'Vampire Messiah' 00:46–01:17

"I know you don't want to humiliate Misty... But can you really manage without it?" she asked. Her voice was lower than usual. She hadn't meant to belittle her, but the urgency was there. If Red fell too far behind Green, he might not be able to catch up."

Red shook his head slowly.

"Not as far as I know. I don't want to take advantage of her kindness. Thanks anyway. Have faith."

Blue did not reply straight away. She looked at him, searching for something in his expression. She found neither arrogance nor false modesty. Just a kind of calm that did not quite put her mind at ease. She finally nodded, half-heartedly.

"...All right."

She walked away without another word, Ivysaur walking beside her. Red was left alone by the side of the road.

He stood motionless for a moment, then turned his gaze towards the tall grass. A few wild Oddish and Bellsprout were moving slowly, oblivious to his presence.

Red slipped his hand into his pocket and drew out a Poké Ball. He held it for a moment, then slowly raised his arm, as if he were about to throw it. His movement was measured, almost hesitant. He held the position for several seconds, his eyes fixed on the wild Pokémon before him.

Finally, he lowered his hand. The Poké Ball fell back against his thigh. His expression remained neutral, showing no trace of anxiety or visible regret. He put the ball back in his pocket with a calm movement.

He had caught nothing. Nor had he resolved anything. He had simply turned down the easy option that had been offered to him.

Red looked up and watched once more as the Oddish and Bellsprout continued to go about their business peacefully in the grass. He made no further move. He simply watched them, hands in his pockets, whilst the twilight continued to fade around him.

End of scene

Scene – The Stringy Flame

Route 24, dusk

The sky was slowly darkening above the road. The grass was already damp, and the air carried that damp chill typical of the evening. Red stood facing Charmeleon, a few metres from the side of the road. The training session was calm, almost silent.

Charmeleon spat a jet of flames forwards. Red watched the movement closely, as he always did. But this time, something caught his attention.

The flames were not quite as they usually were. They seemed thinner, more stringy, and their trajectory showed a slight irregularity, almost as if they were being pulled by something invisible. It was not simply a variation in intensity. It was something else.

Red narrowed his eyes slightly.

BGM: 'Little Boy Belmont' up to 00:25 in this scene

Without a word, he took his Pokédex from his pocket. He opened it with a swift, precise movement and held it in front of him. His gaze scanned the screen cautiously. He remained like that for several seconds, reading and comparing, without finding a clear match. He finally closed the device and put it away slowly.

Charmeleon watched him, waiting for a reaction. Red said nothing. He stood motionless for a moment, his gaze fixed on his Pokémon. His expression was serious and focused, but without a trace of enthusiasm. He was weighing something up in his mind, taking his time.

Then he raised his hand slightly, palm open, in a simple, calm gesture. Charmeleon understood. It returned to position, ready to start again.

Red lowered his hand. He did not seem to have found a definitive answer, only a possible direction. He looked once more at the irregular flames that had dissipated into the air, then raised his eyes to Charmeleon with watchful attention.

He was not certain that this fresh tack would alter the outcome, yet he knew he could not dismiss it. Without saying a word, he gave Charmeleon a slight nod. The training resumed.

End of scene

Scene – The Ambiguous Transformation

Cerulean Gym

BGM: 'Little Boy Belmont' from 00:25

The water in the pool cast a cold, shifting light upon the tiled walls. The air was heavy with humidity, laden with a faint smell of chlorine and wet metal. The buoys still floating on the surface traced slow circles, disturbed by the slightest ripple.

Pikachu was already crouching, out of breath. It fired one final attack: Thunder Wave. Starmie flinched, caught in the invisible web of paralysis. The next bolt, weaker—Thunder Shock—struck its target to little effect. Starmie countered with a fluid movement. A rushing wave crashed over Pikachu and sent him flying backwards. The little Pokémon did not get back up.

Red recalled Pikachu without a word. The Poké Ball flew back to him in a red streak. He caught it, then threw another with a sharp, decisive motion.

Charmeleon appeared. It landed nimbly at the edge of the pool, its claws scraping lightly against the damp tiles. Misty's expression remained unchanged. She was still watching with the same professional attention, but something in her gaze had lost its sharpness. She had seen this scenario far too often before.

Starmie began spinning again, more slowly than at the start of the battle, but with her precision still intact. Her star-shaped arms traced regular circles in the air. The water around her formed small eddies that lapped at the edges of the pool.

Red stood motionless. He closed his eyes for a few seconds. Around him, he could still sense the movement of the water, the gentle lapping against the buoys, the steady swishing of Starmie's arms. When he opened his eyes again, his expression had changed.

BGM: 'Little Boy Belmont' from 01:45

The doubt was still there, but it no longer took centre stage. He looked at Charmeleon. Not a word was spoken. The Pokémon understood.

Charmeleon took a deep breath. Then it spat out a jet of flames.

The flame was not quite its usual shape. It seemed denser, more elongated, as if it were trying to cling on rather than simply burn. It struck Starmie head-on. The paralysis prevented the starfish from turning quickly enough. The flames enveloped its entire body for a moment, longer than an ordinary Fire-type attack would have done.

Misty narrowed her eyes slightly. She sensed something unusual in the way the flames had spread, but she could not quite put her finger on it yet. Starmie lurched one last time, then came to a standstill, floating on the surface of the water in a contorted position.

Silence fell over the gym.

Red had not moved. Neither had Charmeleon. They were both staring at Starmie, as if they were still waiting for something. It was not the victory that seemed to surprise them, but the intensity with which they had struck. The flame had been fiercer than they had intended. More decisive. Almost too much so.

Misty remained silent for a moment. She stared at her Pokémon, then turned her gaze back to Red and Charmeleon. For the first time since the battle had begun, she looked genuinely uncertain.

Red clenched his fists slightly at his sides, without any sense of triumph. He was breathing a little faster than before. Charmeleon kept his eyes fixed on Starmie, his nostrils still steaming.

The water in the pool continued to lap gently against the edges, indifferent.

End of scene

Scene – The Heart's Resilience

Cerulean Gym

The water in the pool continued to lap gently against the edges. Starmie was still floating motionless on the surface. Misty called her back without haste, the Poké Ball closing with a red flash. She remained silent for a moment, her eyes fixed on the spot where her Pokémon had been struck.

Red did not move. Neither did Charmeleon. Both still seemed taken aback by the intensity of what had just happened.

Misty finally spoke, in a low voice:

“That wasn’t a Fire-type move...”

She paused, as if she were still hesitating to put into words what she had realised.

“...It was Dragon Rage.”

Red lowered his head slightly.

“I’m sorry for going too far. I was afraid of losing again. And of letting you down.”

His voice was sincere, yet he did not truly seek to justify himself; he seemed to know that it was no excuse.

Misty studied him for a moment. She drew a slow breath, then looked away towards the water.

“Never mind. I encouraged you to give it your all, and yet I still underestimated you. It was me who wasn’t careful enough.”

Red added sheepishly. “I had to resort to methods I do not like. I did not want Pikachu and Charmeleon to suffer another humiliating defeat. I know it was not very... fair.”

Misty fell silent for a moment. She recalled Starmie with a slow gesture. The Poké Ball returned to her hand. She held it for a moment before putting it away.

"You didn't cheat just for the sake of winning," she replied at last. "You did what was necessary to spare them unnecessary suffering. It's not the same thing."

Red did not know how to reply. He was unsure if her words were meant as consolation, criticism, or merely a way to close the discussion. He remained silent.

Misty then took a small box from her pocket. She opened it and took out the badge shaped like a drop of water. She walked over to Red and placed it directly into his open palm, without ceremony.

"Congratulations."

The badge felt cold to the touch, just as Red had expected. Yet, after a few seconds, a diffuse, indistinct warmth seemed to rise up along his hand. It wasn't a strong sensation, just something vague and hazy. He didn't understand why. He gently closed his fingers around the badge without saying a word.

BGM: *'Part of the Same History'* from 01:07

Misty took a step back. She looked at him for a moment, then asked the question that had occurred to her earlier:

'Why didn't you use a Grass-type Pokémon? It would have been easier for you.'

Red kept his eyes fixed on the badge for a few seconds before replying.

"I did consider it. But... I couldn't bear the thought of putting you through the same thing as Starmie. A Pokémon of the same type as yours, defeated in such a humiliating way. It seemed... unnecessarily cruel to me."

Misty did not reply straight away. Her eyelashes fluttered once, slowly.

Red continued, in a lower voice, almost without thinking:

"Green's always trying to crush me. You... you don't do that. You hold onto your pride, but you don't use it to put others down. It's different. It's as if you respect your own nature, rather than forcing it."

This time, Misty did not look away. She simply stood still, her lips slightly parted, as if searching for an answer that would not come. Her fingers clenched discreetly around the hem of her jacket.

A silence settled between them, neither heavy nor light. Just there.

After a moment, Misty spoke again, in a voice a little lower than usual:

'Listen... I'd like to get to know you a bit better. Is that OK with you?'

Red looked up. He nodded slowly.

"Yes. I'd love to."

They exchanged contact details without saying much else. Red carefully tucked the badge into his pocket, then, without really realising it, rested his hand on it through the fabric, as if to feel its presence against his chest once more.

Misty watched him do this, without comment.

End of scene

Scene – A Barren Place

Cerulean Gym

Blue walked through the gym doors. She paused for a moment when she saw Red and Misty still standing close together. Her gaze briefly fell on the badge Red was still holding in his hand, then she walked forward calmly.

“Congratulations,” she said to Red.

Blue’s voice is neutral, almost light-hearted. Red nods, slightly surprised by her presence. Blue then turns to Misty.

“Could you leave us alone for a moment?”

BGM: ‘Powerful Predatory Deadly’ from 00:44

Red glances from Misty to Blue, unable to fathom the sudden tension, and simply nods.

“...All right.”

He departs without another word. The door swings shut behind him with a thud, and silence settles over the gym, heavier than before.

Misty remains standing, arms crossed. She watches Blue with subtle suspicion. She expects a snide remark, or something that might spoil what she has just experienced with Red. Blue approaches slowly, without aggression. She takes a Poké Ball from her pocket and twirls it absent-mindedly between her fingers.

‘Your reputation precedes you,’ she says.

Misty feels her shoulders tense slightly. She senses a hint of irony in that sentence, or worse, a roundabout way of attacking her. She doesn’t reply straight away.

Blue continues, in a calmer tone:

“You’ve done better than I did. Really.”

The background music stops.

Misty frowns slightly. She had expected anything but that. Blue is not looking at her directly. She is staring at the Ivysaur Poké Ball she is holding in her hands.

“I couldn’t choose Squirtle,” she says. “After a while. Not because I didn’t want to. It’s just... I didn’t really have the choice. And even if I’d been able to, I don’t know if I’d have known how to look after it like you do.”

She pauses. Her voice drops slightly.

“For a long time, I told myself that if things had been different from the start, everything might have turned out differently. It was easier than accepting what had really happened.”

Misty looks at her without saying a word. She is beginning to realise that Blue is not trying to attack her. What she is hearing is heavier – and more personal – than she had imagined.

Blue grips the Poké Ball a little tighter.

“Pretending that nothing had ever happened... it’s easier at first. But eventually, it becomes a way of lying to yourself. And I don’t want to get used to that. Otherwise, I won’t really be able to love anyone else afterwards.”

She finally looks up at Misty. Her expression is weary, but sincere.

“I know where I belong now. And I’m glad it’s with you.”

Misty feels something ease inside her, though it does not disappear completely. She cannot find the words to reply. Blue seems to realise this. She puts the Poké Ball back in her pocket and continues, in a slightly more neutral tone:

“Our paths cross from time to time. If one day you need me to look after him for you... I’ll do it.”

She offers a faint smile that does not reach her eyes.

‘Look after him.’

Blue turns on her heel and departs in turn, without waiting for a reply. The door closes softly behind her.

Misty is left alone in the middle of the gym. The sound of the water lapping against the pool’s edges seems clearer than before. She looks down at her own hands, without moving.

The atmosphere hangs in the air, at once a little lighter and strangely heavy.

End of scene

Transitional scene – The relentlessness of Team Rocket

Celadon City – Evening

BGM ‘EP02 S01 06:30–07:28’

Cold, wide shots of the city. The lights of the Game Corner pierce the night. Inside, through windows and half-open doors, silhouettes in suits exchange briefcases. Men in plain clothes count wads of cash on low tables. Their movements are methodical, almost routine. No shouting, no unnecessary gestures. Just silent transactions.

Rocket Hideout – Basement

We descend into the lower levels. The lighting is dim, a dirty yellow. Grunts in black move through the narrow corridors. They can be seen carrying sealed crates, stacking them methodically. Others are counting money under lamps. Faces are rarely visible. What stands out most are the silhouettes moving to and fro with cold efficiency. The place feels organised, not chaotic.

Transition – Adjacent alleyway

Two men in suits emerge through a side door of the building. One wipes his hands with a white handkerchief. They walk without hurrying. One of them glances back, then continues on his way. The camera follows them for a moment before pulling away.

Pokémon Tower – Night

The atmosphere changes. The tower is plunged into semi-darkness. The air is heavy, almost stagnant. The camera moves slowly through the silent corridors. We eventually come upon Marowak's body, slumped against a stone wall. The scene is not bloody, but the silence is oppressive. The Pokémon is motionless. Around it, there are a few signs of a recent struggle (stirred-up dust, small debris). The atmosphere is that of a deed done, not of a fight still in progress.

The camera lingers for a moment on the body, then slowly pans up towards the upper floors of the tower, as if something were already beginning to take hold there — a presence, a still-diffuse anger.

In the distance, a faint, muffled cry from a small Pokémon can be heard.

End of scene

Scene – The childhood friend's blindness

Saffron City

Effect BGM 'She Who Mauls' 00:41–00:45

A woman's voice called to her softly, as if from the other side of a dream.

"Red."

Red started. His body reacted before his mind did: he jerked his head up slightly, as if emerging from somewhere too dark. For a second, his gaze remained fixed, still caught up in something hostile. His fingers, resting on the edge of the table, clenched before slowly relaxing.

Blue watched him without pressing the issue. She was sitting opposite him, in the subdued light of the library's ground floor. Red's laptop lay open between them, its screen casting a faint glow over their faces.

'Were you daydreaming...?' she asked in a calm voice.

Red blinked several times. It took him a moment to reply, as if he still needed to distinguish reality from what he'd just seen. When he spoke, his voice was a little hoarse.

"...Sorry."

He looked down at the screen, without really seeing it. Blue didn't ask where his mind had wandered to. She waited a moment, then continued in a more neutral tone, as if to help him cling to something tangible.

"We were on the capability reports. You wanted to add something about the last battle."

Red nodded half-heartedly. He rested his hands on the keyboard, but did not begin typing at once. The air in the library was heavy, laden with the dust of old books and the silence of the readers. From

time to time, one could hear the scraping of a chair or the rustle of a page being turned. It was a place made for work, not for confiding in one another.

They returned to their task without another word. Red was passing on to Oak the observations he had noted over the last few days: the development of his Pokémon's abilities, the behaviours he had noticed among passing Trainers. Blue would glance over his shoulder from time to time, adding a comment here and there. It was their routine as Pokédex holders—administrative and a little dreary.

The front door opened. Green walked in. He still had that slightly overconfident swagger, but when he spotted them, his step faltered for a fraction of a second. He saw them both, sitting opposite each other in front of the computer. His expression barely changed, but just enough for Red to notice. Green clenched his jaw slightly, then looked away and went up the stairs to the upper floors without saying hello.

Silence fell between Red and Blue. Red stared at the screen for a moment without really seeing it. Then he shut the computer down with a decisive gesture.

'Let's talk somewhere else,' he said.

Blue did not protest. She rose with him and they left the library.

Outside, the air in Saffron City felt crisper. They walked for a while at a leisurely pace, past the light-coloured stone façades. The sound of traffic was distant, muffled by the buildings. Red kept his hands in his jacket pockets, his gaze fixed on the pavement.

Blue finally broke the silence.

'Say, why are you avoiding Green like that...?'

Red did not answer straight away. He searched for the right words.

"I don't want your company to hurt him unnecessarily. Over something that's none of my business."

Blue understood without him needing to say any more. She nodded slightly.

They carried on walking. After a while, she asked:

"What were you daydreaming about just now...?"

Red kept his eyes on the ground for a moment.

"Team Rocket."

Blue regarded him askance.

"You did quite well against them, didn't you? With all that chivalry of yours..."

There was a hint of irony in his voice, but no real mockery. Red shook his head.

"I'm not trying to be a hero. The grunts aren't that strong, on the whole. But they don't need to be to be dangerous to ordinary Trainers. Without a Pokédex, without any preparation... just facing them takes a lot of courage. I took them on because I had to. Not to show off."

He paused, then added more quietly:

"I reckon the Professor would have done the same, if he were still young."

Blue raised an eyebrow slightly.

“Yet you say you do not idolise him.”

“I don’t idolise him. But without him... this world would probably be a worse place. Science, Trainers... everything. I sometimes wonder if he’s a scientist or... something else. Ensuring justice is done is one way of repaying him for what he’s given me.”

Blue did not reply straight away; she seemed to be thinking.

“You might be taking on too much,” she said at last, with gentle irony.

Red did not pick up on it. They walked on a little further. Then he asked:

“And you... why are you continuing the Professor’s programme?”

Blue shrugged.

“It’s a cushy job, for a start. He didn’t want Bulbasaur to go to waste in the lab. And he didn’t really have any idea what I was supposed to do. So I left. Besides, you lads aren’t very good at catching new specimens. Bulbasaur’s made for that. I’m taking a bit of the strain off you.”

Red smiled faintly, without joy.

“Don’t you find it a bit odd, sometimes? The Pokémon we come across near towns are often weaker than the ones we find further out. As if everything were graded. As if it were... rigged.”

Blue did not reply straight away. She kept her eyes fixed ahead.

“That’s a good question,” she said at last. “But you don’t have to answer it straight away.”

They were now walking along a wider street. A sudden shout made them turn round. A Trainer had just accidentally released an Onix into the middle of the road. The enormous Pokémon was blocking almost the entire street. City officials arrived quickly, calming the Trainer down and directing the passers-by. Red watched the scene without getting any closer.

‘A fine for an unlicensed colossal Pokémon,’ he murmured. ‘Apparently.’

They continued on their way once traffic was able to resume.

After a moment, Red asked:

“Say... you’re close to Green, aren’t you? I don’t mistrust him that much. We used to bump into each other in Pallet Town when we were kids. But we didn’t really talk. I’m not really in a position to judge him.”

Blue fell silent for a moment. When she spoke, her voice was lower.

“He’s not really that arrogant, deep down. He’s simpler than he seems. You’d just need to get a bit closer to him to see that. Even as his rival, like you. That’s probably why you don’t really hate him.”

Red did not know how to reply. He felt as though Blue was talking about a side of Green he did not know.

“And ever since I’ve been travelling,” she continued, “I’ve become even more convinced of it. I’ve also realised that I’m not cut out for long trips.”

Background music: ‘EP04 S02 18:10–19:00’

Red looked at her.

“But you do love exploring.”

“I do love exploring. But I’m not used to leaving my town for too long. In other places... the boys stare at me. They pay me compliments. It’s not always meant maliciously, but it’s superficial. They don’t really see me. And I feel as though I’m losing something. My roots. What makes me who I am. As if layers were being stripped away from me.”

She paused.

“I’m glad I left early. If I’d waited until I was older, I’d probably have lost my way. I’d have given in to things I shouldn’t have. And strangely... it was only when I left that I realised there was still something good about Green after all.”

Red blushed slightly. He hadn’t expected the conversation to take this turn.

Blue looked at him with a slight, wry smile.

“You don’t seem to think about it much, do you? But that’s normal. You’re more resilient than most boys our age. Especially since you met Misty.”

Red could not think of anything to say. He looked down at the pavement.

After a moment, he said, sounding a bit embarrassed:

“If you really meant that much to Green, he’d probably have come with you. Instead of leaving you alone on the streets.”

Blue did not grow angry. She carried on walking, her gaze lost in the distance.

“Yes... he’s hopeless,” she murmured.

There was no anger in her voice. Just a kind of gentle resignation, almost affectionate despite everything.

They walked on in silence for a while longer. The sky above Saffron City was beginning to darken slightly. Red kept his hands in his pockets, feeling awkward, not knowing what else to say. Blue, for her part, simply seemed to accept things as they were, without trying to change them.

End of scene

Scene – The Warmth of Water

Saffron City, hotel room

BGM ‘A Third Soul’ until 01:36 or 01:48

A voice called to him across the silence.

— Red.

Red snapped back to reality. His body stiffened slightly, as if he were emerging from somewhere too deep. He raised his head with a sudden, small movement, his eyes still lost in thought. For a few

seconds, he remained motionless, catching his breath, as if what he had seen – or seen again – had left him breathless.

Then he recognised the voice.

He was alone in his hotel room. The light was off. Only the moon, low and white, streamed in through the half-open window, casting pale rectangles onto the floor and the bed.

Red looked down. The five badges lay in front of him on the duvet. He'd lined them up without really thinking about it. None of them particularly caught his eye. He'd earned them, that was all. He'd paid the price, as always.

He reached out and picked up Misty's.

The badge felt cold to the touch, as it always had. Red turned it over between his fingers, then brought it closer to his face. He looked at it for a long time, his expression blank. Then, slowly, he pressed it against his chest and held it there with both hands. Not too tightly. Just enough to feel it close to him.

He closed his eyes.

At first, he felt nothing but the usual coldness of the metal. Then, little by little, something changed. It wasn't a sharp or intense heat. It was more diffuse, more gradual. As if the coolness of the badge were turning into something lukewarm, almost gentle, right beneath his palm. He thought he could hear, very faintly, the sound of a drop falling. Then another. Steady, almost languid. Water falling somewhere, without haste.

Red did not attempt to analyse the source of this sensation. He knew vaguely that it was connected to her. To Misty. To her absence. But he did not wish to ponder it any further. He simply remained there, eyes half-closed, letting that strange warmth spread through his chest. It was rare. It was fragile. He feared that if he began to think about it, it would all disappear.

He tightened his grip on the badge a little. Not out of possessiveness. More out of fear that it might slip away, that it might drift off. It was silly, he knew. But in the silence of the room, with only the moon as a witness, he let himself do it. He let himself hold on to this little object as if, in some way, it could hold on to something greater. Something that still connected him to someone. And, by extension, to everything else.

He remained like that for a long time, without moving. His breathing had slowed. From time to time, his thumbs would slowly brush over the surface of the badge, as if to make sure it was still there. He wasn't smiling. He didn't look particularly happy either. Just present. As if, for a few minutes, he'd found a foothold in a world that often lacked one.

He didn't try to work out why it was that particular badge that had this effect. He didn't try to work out exactly what it meant. He simply let himself be carried away by it, for as long as the sensation lasted.

Outside, the wind stirred the curtains ever so slightly. The moon continued to shine, white and indifferent, down upon the sleeping city.

Red, for his part, lay still. He held the badge against his chest, both hands clasped around it, and listened – without really hearing it – to the slow trickle of something that sounded like water.

End of scene

Scene – The Elegant Spectre

Silph Co

BGM « My Sister » 00:30

The battle was already underway.

The air in the Silph Co. corridor reeked of gas and burnt flesh. Charizard hovered low, its wings spread wide in the confined space, its claws outstretched. Opposite them, the Grunts, the scientist and the Gypsy Juggler formed a disorderly semicircle. Their Pokémon advanced with no apparent coordination, yet with a collective malice, as if they knew that their numbers and status would be enough.

Red said nothing. He merely made a brief, almost imperceptible gesture with his left hand. Charizard understood.

A jet of flame tore through the air (Flamethrower). Sandslash was the first to be swept away, its body curling up under the heat. Magnetron followed immediately, its magnets detaching with a metallic crackle. Hypno was struck by the same blast from the side and staggered back, its fur blackened, half-collapsed to the ground.

Charizard did not pause. Its wings flapped once and a blade of air sliced through the corridor (Air Slash). Machoke was hurled against the wall. Hypno, already weakened, collapsed. Kadabra vanished in a flash before the blow could reach it.

Marowak then stepped forward. Without hesitation, he hurled his bone.

The first Bonemerang whistled through the air. Charizard dodged it with a flap of his wing, but the second came too quickly. He had to twist mid-air. His balance faltered for a fraction of a second. The bone whizzed past his flank, missing by just a few centimetres. Before it could return to its master, Charizard opened its mouth and a second Flamethrower engulfed Marowak. The Pokémon collapsed. The bone continued on its trajectory and crashed to the ground, with no master to catch it.

At that very moment, Golbat struck.

As Charizard regained altitude, a blurry beam struck him squarely in the face. His eyes widened. His flight became erratic. He shook his head once, twice, but the disorientation was already setting in, heavy and cloying.

Kadabra reappeared to its right. Without a word, it raised the spoons.

Confusion struck.

Charizard screamed. It wasn't a cry of anger. It was a sharp, internal pain, as if something were twisting his skull from within. Despite the difference in level, Kadabra's strike was precise, clinical. Charizard staggered in the air, his wings flapping erratically.

Golbat seized the opportunity and swooped down on him, wings outstretched.

Red made a sharp, almost violent flick of his wrist.

Charizard reacted despite the confusion. A black claw struck down (Dragon Claw), then, in the same motion, a wing sliced through the air (Wing Attack). Golbat was hurled against the ceiling and crashed down without a sound. Charizard did not stop. He turned towards Kadabra and struck it with a second Wing Attack. Kadabra tried to teleport, but it was too late. It collapsed.

The confusion had not yet cleared.

Weezing then rose slowly and spat a jet of purplish sludge. The sludge stuck to Charizard's body. A cold burning sensation spread beneath his scales. Charizard growled, his mouth wide open, and responded with one final Flamethrower. Weezing exploded in a cloud of gas before crashing to the ground.

Silence fell abruptly.

The remaining Grunts backed away. The scientist and the Gypsy Juggler made no move. Charizard landed heavily, his wings still trembling, the poison already visible as dark patches on his flank. Red stepped forward immediately, pulling an antidote from his pocket.

It was then that he saw it.

BGM: 'My Sister' 01:30

At the end of the corridor, in the blind spot formed by two walls, a man dressed in white stood. Motionless. Elegant. Hands behind his back. No expression on his face. No hatred. No satisfaction. Just a cold, detached observation, almost administrative and scientific.

Red froze, the antidote still in his hand.

The man didn't move. He didn't even seem to be breathing. His presence felt too pristine for this place, too sharp, as if he didn't really belong in the room. Red felt something tighten in his chest. It wasn't ordinary fear. It was colder. Older.

Red blinked.

When he looked again, the corridor was empty.

He stood frozen for another second. His gaze drifted briefly to the floor, then returned to the spot where the man had been standing a moment earlier. He'd felt that presence before, on several occasions. But this time... was it really a man of flesh and blood, the one who had intercepted him before without ever revealing himself? Or had a third party chosen to make itself known in this way, as a bitter greeting, a silent warning? A spectre? A mirage projected solely for him?

His fingers tightened slightly around the antidote. He blinked once more, more slowly. A very slight twitch ran through his jaw before disappearing. Then he looked down at Charizard and administered the remedy. His hand trembled barely, but enough for the movement to lose a fraction of its usual precision.

BGM: 'My Sister' 01:54

The director's office was already occupied.

Giovanni was standing by the large desk, with Nidoking to his right. The director of Silph Co. was seated, his face pale, a Master Ball resting between them. No one was speaking. When Red entered, Giovanni turned his head slightly. His gaze was calm, almost polite. Nidoking, for his part, moved half

a step, just enough to position himself between Red and his trainer. The message was clear, without a single word:

Don't meddle in grown-ups' affairs.

Red halted. He did not reply. The air in the office felt colder than in the corridor. Giovanni regarded him for another second, then turned his attention back to the director, as if Red had never existed.

BGM 'My Sister' 02:11–end

Elsewhere, at another time.

Documents were spread out on a metal table in an overly pristine room at Pokémon Mansion. Diagrams. Handwritten notes. Calculations. Photographs of cells. A plan annotated in tight handwriting. In the centre of the room stood an opaque tank. Inside, something stirred ever so slightly, still shapeless, still incomplete.

Mewtwo had not yet been born.

But someone, somewhere, was already preparing the Master Ball that was to contain it.

End of scene

Scene – The Rotten Summit

Viridian Gym (Day)

Daylight streamed in through the gym's tall windows, illuminating the pale stone of the floor and walls. The air was dry, heavy with the scent of freshly turned earth and warm stone. The silence was unusual for a place like this. No sound of footsteps, no shouts from training sessions. Only the faint whistling of the wind as it passed between the columns.

BGM: 'Reborn'

Red stopped dead in his tracks as he entered. He felt his stomach knot.

'How...?' he murmured, almost to himself.

In the centre of the arena, Giovanni stood perfectly still. He was still wearing the Gym Leader's uniform, but something about his posture had changed. He didn't seem surprised. He merely turned his head slightly towards Red, looking at him with a direct, cold assessment, as if he'd already begun the battle in his mind.

Giovanni said nothing. He merely lifted his chin slightly, as if inviting Red onto the arena without needing to utter a single word. His gaze never left the young Trainer.

Red stood frozen for a moment. His fingers clenched around Charizard's Poké Ball. Although he understood, intellectually, what this meant, the physical shock was greater than he'd anticipated. His shoulders tensed slightly, as if to hold back something that threatened to escape.

'Are you the strongest Gym Leader...?' asked Red in a louder voice, though it trembled almost imperceptibly at the end.

Giovanni still did not reply. He merely took a step to the side, clearing the space on the arena floor. His stance was clear: the challenge was accepted. And there was nothing more to be said.

Red drew a deep breath. He knew that this battle was now inevitable. He also knew that something inside him had just snapped. Yet he stepped forward.

Charizard had just defeated one of Giovanni's Pokémon.

On the other side, Giovanni released Nidoking.

The battle began without a word.

Nidoking attacked first. An **Ice Beam** shot out, followed almost immediately by a **Thunderbolt**. Charizard dodged both attacks, but with a slight delay. He was not clumsy, merely less precise than usual, as if he required an extra fraction of a second to decide. He appeared to be paying excessive attention to the distance between himself and Nidoking, as if distracted by something he did not fully understand.

Red sensed his own unease rubbing off on the creature. He was giving his commands a little too early, a little too hastily. Charizard obeyed, but without his usual fluidity.

On the third exchange, Red ordered a **Flamethrower** from too close a range. Charizard obeyed. The jet of flame struck Nidoking head-on. The purple Pokémon staggered back several paces, its skin burnt over a large area of its flank. It had lost a significant portion of its strength.

Yet Nidoking did not collapse.

He remained standing, his eyes narrowed in pain. And just as Charizard was preparing to launch his next attack, rocks began to rise silently from the ground around him.

Charizard did not perceive this at once; his attention remained divided, as though he sought both to assail and to watch for some other threat.

It was too late.

Nidoking unleashed **Stone Edge**.

The rocks shot out with brutal force. Charizard took the full brunt of the blow. The impact was devastating. The Rock-type's weakness was laid bare in all its cruelty. He was hurled backwards and crashed heavily to the ground.

Charizard did not lose consciousness. He lay there, half-propped up on one forearm, his body shaking. His breathing was ragged. He could still feel everything. The pain was sharp and deep, as if something inside him had snapped.

Red could not help but be shaken by the sight.

His body tensed violently, as if he himself had taken the blow. His eyes misted over instantly. He blinked several times, his jaw clenched so tightly his teeth creaked, struggling to hold back what was welling up inside him. His hands clenched the edge of the pitch with futile force. He was not quite crying, yet the tears were there, ready to spill over. He held them back. With great difficulty.

Giovanni, still silent, watched the scene without giving anything away. His expression was calm. Almost satisfied.

Charizard, on the ground, slowly raised his head. He was gasping for breath. He was in pain. But he hadn't given up.

Red, for his part, remained standing.

His heart was pounding too hard. His gaze fixed on his Pokémon. And something, deep inside him, had just changed forever.

End of scene

Scene – The Ugliness of the Supreme Predators

Viridian Gym (Day)

BGM: *'Family in Heart'*

In his mind, Red remained on his knees. Charizard lay on the ground, his body shaking, his breathing ragged. Tears continued to stream down the young Trainer's face, silently, as if he no longer had the strength to hold them back.

He raised his head slightly towards Giovanni.

'Why such sadism...?' said Red in a low, strained voice. 'That Nidoking's Stone Edge... it was specifically meant to crush my Charizard.'

Giovanni regarded him in silence for a moment, then spoke in a calm, almost reasonable tone, like an adult explaining something obvious to a child.

"If you thought I would not take action against threats like you... you are wrong. This is the price we pay for having prevented the capture of the strongest Pokémon. With it, we would have become the most powerful. Even beyond the gods. You should have joined us. You would have spared yourself this suffering."

Red mechanically wiped a tear from his cheek with the back of his hand, without really making it disappear. When he spoke again, his voice was firmer, but still veiled by emotion.

"This pain doesn't come from the wound... nor from my pride. It comes from seeing just how hideous humans can be."

Alternative cue for BGM *'Family in Heart'*

He raised his head fully. His gaze was clouded, but direct.

'I expected a certain sense of honour from the strongest Gym Leader,' said Red. 'You present yourself as a guide, almost like a god... But you're nothing but a calculating, hypocritical predator. The battle, the rules, the status... all of it serves only to feed your vanity and your personal interests. You respect the rules of battle, but not the slightest trace of existential morality. It's all just performance and pretence.'

Charizard, still on the ground, turned his head weakly towards Red. He could hear him. He understood. A glimmer of regret and helplessness flashed across his eyes. He would have liked to get back up. He couldn't.

Giovanni remained silent for a moment. This was not the sort of speech he had been expecting. He had heard children address him before about friendship, justice or the love of Pokémon. But this... this was different. Colder. More precise. Harder to brush aside. His gaze hardened slightly, but he could not think of a reply straight away.

Red, for his part, pulled himself together in an instant.

With a sharp, almost violent gesture, he wiped away his tears. His expression changed abruptly. The vulnerability vanished, replaced by a cold determination. Without another word, he recalled Charizard into its Poké Ball with a precise, urgent movement.

He immediately seized another Poké Ball and hurled it forcefully into the air. The Poké Ball opened mid-air. Espeon emerged, already on the move, body taut, eyes gleaming. As soon as it touched the ground, it spun with startling speed and unleashed **Psychic** on Nidoking. The blow was clean, violent, and struck directly at an obvious weakness in the purple Pokémon. Nidoking was sent flying backwards, unable to resist.

Giovanni recalled Nidoking somewhat hastily and immediately sent out **Rhydon**.

Red recalled Espeon with equal speed.

He seized Lapras's Poké Ball, held it close for a moment and whispered a few words, very softly, just loud enough for Lapras to hear through the sphere. Then he hurled it with great force, whilst perfectly controlling its trajectory to minimise spin. Lapras appeared already facing Rhydon.

Without wasting a second, Lapras unleashed **Hydro Pump**.

The jet of water was precise, surgical, almost clinical. It struck Rhydon head-on. The Water-type weakness manifested itself in all its ferocity. Rhydon was violently knocked back and collapsed, unable to get back to its feet.

The BGM 'Family in Heart' came to an end at that very moment.

Red remained standing, breathless, his gaze fixed on the battlefield. His eyes were dry now. Only a very slight redness around his eyelids still bore witness to what he had just been through.

End of scene

Scene – The Fate of the Strongest

Telephone box in Viridian City

BGM: 'EP04 S01 03:47–05:00'

The telephone box in Viridian City was cramped and dimly lit. Red held the receiver in one hand, the other pressed against the glass panel. Outside, the noise of the street seemed distant, almost muffled.

Misty's voice rang out, calm but clearly shaken.

"I'm so sorry about what you've been through... It's too outrageous."

Red kept his eyes fixed on the floor of the box. His voice was low, a little hoarse.

"Yes... He announced the dissolution of Team Rocket right in front of me. He was too frustrated, I suppose."

Misty was silent for a moment.

"Wasn't that just an excuse?"

Red gripped the handset slightly.

"Yes. He seemed like a noble warrior or bushi, but he simply didn't want to face the consequences... A rhetorical irresponsibility. I know I should have had him arrested on the spot. But I was too shaken. I wasn't able to react as I should have."

On the other end of the line, Misty made no overt attempt to console him. She simply seemed to be listening attentively, without trying to dominate the conversation.

Red continued, in a lower voice:

"Once they've ruined everything, some adults go home safe and sound. And their successors emerge. Who knows what the Grunts who remain will do..."

He paused briefly, then added, almost as if apologising:

"Sorry to fill you in on all this, Misty."

"It's all right," she replied softly. "But you should learn to share this sort of thing a bit more. You don't have to carry it all on your own."

Red did not reply straight away. He stared at the dial, without really seeing it. When he spoke again, his voice had changed. It was lower, more hesitant.

"After what's happened... I sometimes wonder if I should still be aiming for the League."

Misty said nothing. Red could only hear her breathing, slightly uneven, at the other end of the line.

He lowered his head, and this time the words came out with a certain bitterness, almost in spite of himself:

"Is that the fate of the strongest? To become like Giovanni?"

The silence that followed was heavier than the words.

Misty did not reply.

End of scene

Final scene – Let's battle バトルしようぜ

Route 22 was bathed in an orange and purplish twilight. A gentle breeze blew across the pond, rippling the surface of the water and the tall grass. The air was cool, almost biting.

Red stood alone by the side of the road. He had taken out the badge he'd received from Giovanni and was clutching it in his palm. He looked at it with obvious reluctance, as if he found its touch hard to bear. Yet he couldn't bring himself to throw it away. It was a victory, but it felt hollow, almost bitter.

In his mind he was continuing the thought he had had earlier with Misty. *'Is this the fate of the strongest? Do they all end up like Giovanni?'*

He slowly raised his head and turned his gaze towards the League, without really seeing it. His expression was troubled, as if he were searching for an answer he could not yet put into words.

Behind him, a voice rang out, light and natural:

"Hi, Red."

Red took a little longer than usual to react. He turned round slowly.

BGM: 'Vampire Messiah' from 01:38

It was Green.

Green stood there, hands in his pockets, with a relaxed smile. His tone was easy-going, almost cheerful, as if nothing serious had happened recently.

"Let's battle."

Red did not reply straight away; he watched Green in silence.

Green seemed full of energy, lively, almost impatient. There was a glint in his eyes that was too intense, too fiery. As if something were driving him from within, without him being fully aware of it. It wasn't pure malice. It was more insidious. A form of structural blindness. The idea of becoming the strongest seemed to have consumed him to the point of making him almost dependent on it, without him realising just how toxic this frenzy could be.

Red glanced down briefly at the green badge he was still holding in his hand.

The colour. Green.

He made the connection without needing to say it out loud. Green's obsession with strength, his desire to dominate, his way of seeing the world as a constant arena of competition... all of this harboured something dangerously close to what Giovanni embodied. And Green, with his privileges, his connections, his position, was even more likely to go down that path without even realising it.

Red looked up at him.

Green was still waiting for him, with that same impatient, almost feverish energy, oblivious to what had just flashed across Red's face.

Red said nothing.

He simply stood there, silent, the badge still clenched in his palm. His expression was calm on the surface, but his gaze was heavy, uncertain, as if he'd just realised something important without yet knowing what to make of it.

Green, for his part, continued to smile slightly, waiting for a reply that never came.

The scene ended on that silence.

End of episode

Close of episode

Totals

Scenes: 20 · Words: ≈ 14,900 · Read aloud: ≈ 100 min · 36 pp. A4 (copy).

Arc compilation. Possible split: Cerulean / Silph–Viridian.

Pass 1/3 — still open

Anchors: Cerulean, Magikarp. one of the co-presidents. smartened yourself up (not made more of an effort). Speakers to label. Cut “the scene ends”, “off-menu”, Notes and Alternative cut (moved here). Air Slash not pasted as a label. Reborn and A Third Soul: spans. Let’s battle (not Let us fight). phone dial (not screen). Blue: her background. silence was sharp.

Version notes

2026-09-23 — EN-GB apparatus after P1. Aligned with episode 02. Technical notes isolated. Pieces / traces. EN anchors. Author filled to match 02–04. Imprecation retained (not Curse).

Open for what follows

Rhetorical dissolution · fate of the strongest · Green · man in white · Master Ball / tank.

BGM credits

Castlevania: Nocturne (Netflix). Spans: index. Traces ≠ titles.